

Eleventh International Olympiad in Linguistics

Manchester (Great Britain), July 22–26, 2013

Individual Contest Solutions

Problem #1. Rules:

1. If the number of syllables in the word (= stem + ending) is even, all syllables are short. If the number of syllables in the word is odd, the last even-numbered syllable of the stem is lengthened.

2 = 2 + 0:	bu₁ja²-∅	3 = 2 + 1:	ba₁ma:² -gu₃
4 = 2 + 2:	bu₁ja²-gi₃mbal⁴	3 = 3 + 0:	gu₁da:²ga₃-∅
4 = 3 + 1:	gu₁da²ga₃-bi⁴	5 = 3 + 2:	ju₁du:²lu₃ -mu⁴jay₅
4 = 4 + 0:	mu₁yu²ba₃ra⁴-∅	5 = 4 + 1:	ga₁ja²gi₃mba:⁴ -gu₅

2. If the ending **-ni** or **-mu** immediately follows a long vowel, it loses its own vowel.

(a) **mugaɽumu**, **waɲa:lgu**.

(b) **bama:n** — of a person, **bupa:bi** — another woman, **maɟurmuɟay** — with a frog, **muɟa:mni** — of a mother.

(c) of a stranger — **muyubara:n**, for a fishing net — **mugaɽugu**, father — **bimbi**, from a frog — **maɟu:rmu**, without a man — **wagu:ɟagimbal**, of a pigeon — **juduluni**, tortoise — **baɟi:gal**, without a boomerang — **waɲalgimbal**.